

task is therefore left to large deployers, ISPs and providers of open source cloud solutions, and several options are already available on the market.

Since LibreOffice Online requires integration with many other technologies to allow deployment, The Document Foundation does not maintain binaries for enterprise use. Even if it were reasonable to pre-select all the elements of a deployment stack, providing enterprise production binaries would create expectations which could not be fulfilled by volunteer based support. The Document Foundation is keen to avoid any situation in which an unsuitable version is deployed at scale. So when used in something like an enterprise situation (more than 10 concurrent documents and/or more than 20 connections) LibreOffice Online will display a prominent 'Not supported' warning while continuing to function.

LibreOffice Portable

LibreOffice Portable is a full-featured portable version of LibreOffice for Windows – including a word processor, spreadsheet, presentation tool, drawing package and database – packaged as a portable app, so that all documents and everything needed to work with them can be taken wherever you go. It is packaged in *PortableApps.com* format

and so can work with the *PortableApps.com* platform and its automatic updater and app store. It can work with other portable menus, or work by itself from a USB, cloud or local drive.

LibreOffice is ideal for home and small office users but The Document Foundation does not provide technical support.

If LibreOffice is to be deployed in a larger organisation, it is strongly recommended to source it from one of LibreOffice's ecosystem partners. In that way, people can get long-term supported releases, personalised assistance, customised new features, bug fixes and other benefits. Also, the work done by ecosystem partners flows back into the LibreOffice project, benefiting everyone.

LibreOffice 6.3.0 (2019-08-08) – a fresh branch

The latest 'fresh' version of LibreOffice, recommended for technology enthusiasts, contains new features and program enhancements. This version may contain a few annoying bugs, which will be fixed in the next bugfix

versions to come. LibreOffice 6.3.0 is the first release of the fresh line.

LibreOffice 6.2.5 (2019-07-04) – a still branch

The mature 'still' version of LibreOffice is recommended for more conservative users. As such, the version is stable and is suitable for all users. LibreOffice 6.2.5 is the sixth bugfix release of the still line.

While open source software is obtained free, it comes with issues. One is the frequency of updates, which depends solely on the developers. Frequent updates are preferred so that the software remains useful. Another issue is the stability of the software. Business-critical software must be stable and bug-free. Compatibility with the proprietary software used by business partners is another issue. A company that has chosen to use FOSS must be able to open a document sent by a business partner who uses proprietary software.

My company has developed what it calls the MultiSpectra OS. This consists of Ubuntu Linux with LibreOffice, Scribus, GIMP, Inkscape, Firefox, Thunderbird and VLC media player. **END** 

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OSFY Magazine Attractions During 2019-20

MONTH	THEME
March 2019	Mobile/Web App Development and Optimisation
April 2019	Cybersecurity, Open Source Firewall, Network Security and Monitoring
May 2019	AI, Deep Learning and Machine Learning
June 2019	DevOps Special
July 2019	Blockchain and Open Source
August 2019	Database Management and Optimisation
September 2019	Open Source and IoT
October 2019	Cloud Special: BigData, Hadoop, PaaS, SaaS, IaaS and Cloud
November 2019	Open Source on Windows
December 2019	Open Source Programming (Languages and Tools)
January 2020	Data Security, Storage and Backup
February 2020	Best in the World of Open Source (Tools and Services)